

McMahon Wins In Relief Role

Braves Rally to
Win Wild Contest

By PETE LIGHTNER

Early Sports Editor
The battling Braves staged another sparkling comeback Tuesday night to beat Indianapolis 10 to 8 and keep pace with the sizzling Saints in the torrid Association race. The Braves are still a few percentage points out of the lead, although virtually tied for first. Wichita passed Minneapolis by half a game when the Millers were rained out.

Last night's victory made it two in a row over the league champions of 1956. It was just about the wildest game of the season, everything happened, including the proverbial balk, and a fist fight was in the making but got sidetracked.

Wichita spotted the Indians a 5 to 0 lead in the first and came back with a home run attack in the fourth, a flock of singles in the big seventh along with an error in the outfield which let in a couple of runs.

Don McMahon, third Wichita pitcher won it, just after he had orders to go back to Milwaukee. It was his sixth victory. Carlton Willey again found that winning No. 13 was a toughie. He didn't last long.

But if the Wichita pitching was off, the Indianapolis hurling was worse. Manager Andy Cohen's staff is well battered and he is baffled at who will pitch tonight for the Indians.

Wichita's hospital list, already very long was increased when catcher Mike Roarke suffered a groin injury and had to retire in the eighth. However, trainer Harvey Stone believed he could play Wednesday.

There was a high total of 27 hits rattled off the bats of the two teams, 14 for Wichita and 13 for the Indians, against the half dozen fingers.

The near-fight came up in the seventh when McMahon threw a high inside pitch which nicked Joe Valdivieso on his dome. The Cuban resented the blow and started after McMahon, the burly pitcher meeting him halfway. However, the umpires and managers got out before any punches were thrown and Vaidy suffered apparently only an injury to his pride as he continued to play.

Neil Christley, subbing for Jim Delsing, who turned up sick, put Indianapolis ahead in the first with a 3-run homer off Willey. The Indians added two more on three hits in the second before Harry Hanebrink broke the ice for Wichita with his 14th home run, in last of the second, none on base. This came off Duke Markell, starting Indians' hurler. The Braves really started biting the Indians rightlander in the fourth when Hanebrink tripled, Earl Herah got his 11th homer and Ray Shearer followed with a tremendous shot over deep center, for his 12th.

Fans Happy
That made it 5 to 4 and the fans were happy again. However, Indianapolis took a lead of 8 to 6 in the sixth, scoring two more.

The Braves had their clinching inning in the seventh when with one away, Koppe, Hazle and Malkmus singled in rapid order. Hanebrink flied out on a long ball to center but the Braves got a break. Herah, after grounding to third, was given a free ticket on a catcher's interference with his bat.

Then Shearer rapped a stizzling hit to center, which ran through Beard's legs to the fence and everyone scored but Shearer, the four runs giving Wichita a 9 to 8 lead. The Braves increased it by one in the eighth on two hits and a sacrifice fly.

GAME NOTES — Don McMahon will leave for Milwaukee early this morning, and should be in Beersville by nightfall. The official announcement stated that Milwaukee had "purchased his contract," a quaint baseball term meaning Wichita no longer has the ace reliever, whose fireball pitching has saved several games. Don was generally considered the best long range reliever in the circuit.—Ray Ripplinger, former Illinois basketball star, will now go on the Wichita active list. Ray has his official army discharge and has won three games for Fort Leonard Wood since leaving Wichita. He was on a leave for six weeks and pitching one inning in a relief chore.—Third game of the series comes up tonight at 8 with Joe Jay going after his fifth straight. He's been Wichita's best pitcher in June. Cloyd Boyer, former K. C. pitcher, was slated to tell for the Indians, but he worked an inning last night so manager Ampt may have to look around some more.—"Who do you think you are, the Yankees and White Sox?" some fan yelled when the clubs started squaring off.—The game lacked the outright infighting of the night before, but it was a perfect piece of entertainment for fans who like action, and in big chunks.